or paramilitary forces. Scato Swu was nominated by the Government of India to represent his people in the Rajya Sabha.

I would like to highlight a factor that has not received due recognition: the resounding and unsettling impact of India's decisive victory in the Indo-Pak war of 1971 on insurgencies in the northeast. During this campaign, we were pleasantly surprised to bag self-styled General Thinouselie and members of his gang undergoing training in erstwhile East Pakistan. Their surrender to our forces was an unexpected bounty, and it definitely had an adverse effect on the Naga rebellion. On 11 November 1975, the Shillong Peace Accord was signed between the Government of India and representatives of the Naga underground organizations, including the Naga Federal Government, which ended the two-decade-old insurgency. In this accord, they agreed of their own volition to unconditionally accept the Constitution of India, lay down arms and formulate other issues for the final settlement of the Naga problem. However, this agreement ran into heavy weather as the Isaac Swu- and T. Muivah-led gang, returning from China in 1975, 'denounced the Accord'.[8] They formed the National Socialist Council of Nagaland (NSCN), which subsequently split up following a bloody clash in April 1988. This saw the emergence of another faction of the NSCN, led by S.S. Khaplang, a Burmese Naga. Besides the NSCN, there were some other dissidents of the Shillong accord too. Sadly, this accord could not usher in an era of peace. A phase of violence erupted, which was initiated by the NSCN. Eventually, after a decade of bitter fighting, a ceasefire agreement was signed between the NSCN (IM) and the Government of India in July 1997, which has been periodically extended.

At present, there is a ceasefire between the army and both of the Naga armed factions, namely the NSCN Isaac & Muivah (IM) group and the NSCN Khaplang (K) group. They have parcelled out territories in all Naga-inhabited areas of the region, including Myanmar, Manipur, Assam and Arunachal Pradesh, based on ethnic and tribal affinities. There are ongoing inter-factional clashes in which both sides have suffered a number of fatal casualties. To add to the prevailing confusion, recently a further split has taken place